



Security Watch

Communication, Interrupted

Bugger, An Overflow

A new vulnerability in MSN and Windows Live Messenger could let Malicious Forces take control of your PC simply by inviting you to video chat. The root cause of this is a buffer-overflow error. The vulnerability affects all versions of MSN Messenger between 6.2 and 8.0.

Solution

The problem has been fixed in Windows Live Messenger 8.1, so download the update.

Hello, Virus

"Hey, where I put ur photo :-> now u populr. oops sorry please dont look there. look what crazy photo Tiffany sent me, looks cool." If you receive this (or a similar) grammatically heinous message in Skype, don't click the link! This is how the Skipi.A virus spreads over Skype. It disables anti-virus programs, blocks security-related sites, installs a password sniffer and spreads itself to your friends.

Solution

Update your anti-virus program. If already infected, download the update from another PC and install it to yours.

STRONGER, HIGHER, ...

Intel: Graphics, Physics, And More

Earlier this year, in June, rumours said Intel was set to challenge AMD and NVIDIA's dominance of the GPU arena with a discrete graphics unit of its own. Now, CEO Paul Otellini indicated at the Intel Developer Forum in September that the company could be on track to demonstrate, in 2008, the capabilities of Larrabee—"a highly-parallel, many-core product comprised of an array of Intel architecture cores." This will indeed be a discrete graphics processor, Otellini revealed. He believes Larrabee would have applications in supercomputing and in physics applications, amongst others. But most importantly, Otellini said Larrabee would be very good at graphics—"teraflops of performance."

Then, Intel also has plans to increase *integrated graphics* performance by a factor of ten by 2010. Current Integrated Graphics Processor (IGP) chipsets are built on a 90nm fabrication process; however, Otellini has said we'll get to see 65nm integrated graphics products in early 2008, which will mean roughly double the performance we now have. Some have commented—and rightly—that this in itself is not much of a statement: integrated graphics today is slow to say the least, so double the performance doesn't mean "very fast."

What will be very fast, though, is when integrated graphics chipsets move to a 45nm process. This will be the first time the IGP will be manufactured on the same process as the CPU; in fact, the IGP will be integrated into the CPU.

It doesn't end there: September reports say Intel will buy Havok, one of the two major developers of physics technology for games—the other being Ageia, which you'll recall if you've been reading past issues of *Digit*. Havok's software allows game

HOT

The Torrent Sites



September 15, MediaDefender's internal e-mails had been leaked onto the Internet was reported by TorrentFreak.com. And now the torrent sites all know what MD is up to. "How sweet when the deceitful fall," one poster said.

MediaDefender

The company with the agenda of keeping the torrents down has fallen. Sure they try and reduce piracy, but how? In their leaked mails are hundreds of IPs and logins to their servers, lists of their decoy trackers and strategies, and much more.

NOT



developers to send physics calculations to the GPU, which is better-designed than the CPU is for those computations—though some debate this. Currently, Havok's code ties into GPUs from both NVIDIA and AMD. It seems all too logical, the purchase of Havok—what with Intel's plans for its own GPU. In addition, it's not only about physics and games: science and

Opinion Poll (You, too, can participate in this poll—at www.thinkdigit.com)

We asked a few of our readers what they thought about owning a laptop.

- a I have one, but I use it quite like a Desktop
b I own one and use it a lot on the move

- c They're only a style statement—not for me
d For a reason other than (c), I don't plan on getting one

c



"It'll be (c). I don't like to carry around the weight of a laptop with me. My cell phone is more than sufficient for e-mail and surfing!"

Jaydeep Mohan Joshi, Mumbai

b



"(b) for me—I use it more for official work. The device is a necessity while you fly, go for client visits, or any other work—and everything on the company is just a click away while you are on the move."

Kalash Udupure, Kolkata

b



"My answer is (b)... I love my laptop! It makes work easy when I am on the move. As a student, I still can be in touch with my friends and follow my syllabus. It's just not a style statement for me; it provides me all the tech news that I need. I use my mobile phone to go online."

M A Azeemija, Eluru

a



"Option (a). I use my laptop only for checking mail, to chat, get on online forums, and transfer photos. These rank the highest in my usage of the laptop. The main reason I chose a laptop over a Desktop is to use the same computer at work and at home, not for its mobility."

Deepak Chander, Chennai

b



"I'll choose (b). In college, during presentations, my laptop was a handy tool. It allows me to work while travelling. It allows me to transfer data from my friends' computers, and I have my hard disk's capacity instead of a pen drive."

Arun Kumar Singla, Patiala

d



It has to be (d). Laptops are not just style statements, they are also a waste of money. I'm a gamer, so a laptop is a sheer waste of money—hardware upgrades aren't possible! I am happy with my Desktop, and would never want a laptop.

Ayush Gupta, Kolkata